



b. 1954 · Welsh management consultant and researcher.

"Match the response to the kind of problem."

THE WHY THAT DROVE THE WORK

Snowden argues that leaders fail when they apply the same management approach to fundamentally different kinds of problem, and that complex situations demand probing and adaptation, not rigid planning.

INTELLECTUAL FOUNDATION

Developed while at IBM, his Cynefin framework draws on complexity science and knowledge management to distinguish ordered from unordered domains.

FRAMEWORKS ANCHORED IN THIS COURSE

He anchors the Cynefin Framework in Unit 5's business-agility Slibrary.

HOW THE IDEAS OPERATIONALISE

Cynefin operationalises as diagnosing a situation's domain and matching the response — best practice, expertise, safe-to-fail experiments, or rapid action.

LIMITATIONS & CRITIQUE

Domain boundaries can be ambiguous in practice, and the framework is a sense-making aid rather than a predictive model.

ENDURING IMPACT

Cynefin is widely used in management, software and public policy as a tool for navigating complexity and uncertainty.

ON THE SAME PANEL (UNIT 5)

John Boyd · Giant 2

Clayton Christensen · Giant 3

John Kotter · Giant 22

Donald Miller · Giant 23

SOURCES (HARVARD REFERENCING STYLE)

Snowden, D.J. and Boone, M.E. (2007) 'A leader's framework for decision making', Harvard Business Review, 85(11).

Kurtz, C.F. and Snowden, D.J. (2003) 'The new dynamics of strategy', IBM Systems Journal, 42(3).